

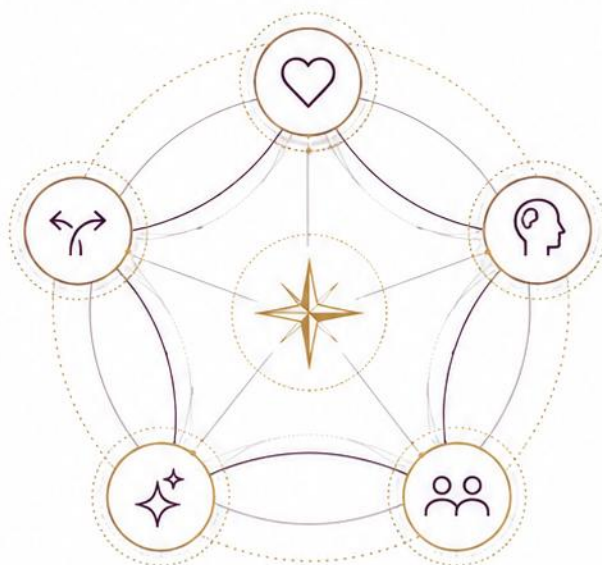


PEOPLE.
POSSIBILITY.
PERFORMANCE.

CATCH Human Capability Framework

Hospitality Advantage | Human Capability Architecture

A practical framework for teaching, observing, and assessing the human capabilities that matter most in AI-enabled hospitality.



Care



Adaptability



Think



Create Exceptional
Experiences



Human
Connection

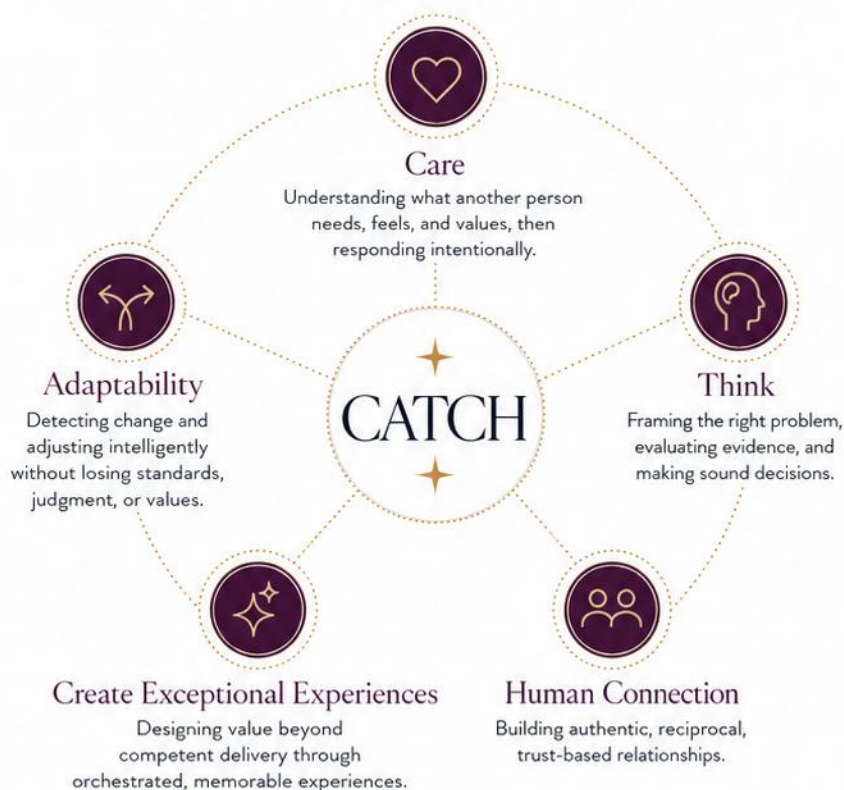


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Executive Overview

What CATCH develops in AI-enabled hospitality

The CATCH Human Capability Framework defines five essential, human capabilities that unlock advantage in an AI-enabled hospitality world. These capabilities work together to elevate performance, strengthen culture, and create experiences that technology cannot replicate.



Purpose

To provide a practical framework for teaching, observing, and assessing the human capabilities that create value beyond automation.

Framework Logic

- Each capability is teachable.
- Each capability is observable.
- Each capability is assessable.



CARE

Understanding what matters to others — and responding with judgment.

1 DEFINITION

Care is the capacity to perceive another person's situation accurately, understand their experience through empathy, discern the needs and values that matter in that moment, and translate that understanding into an intentional response that improves the human outcome.

2 WHY IT MATTERS IN HOSPITALITY

- Guests and colleagues do not always state what they need. The technically correct response is not always the experientially correct one. Care improves the quality of judgment by revealing needs, emotions, values, and context that are not always visible.
- In AI-enabled hospitality, machines can surface patterns and options at scale, but humans remain responsible for meaning, empathy, and the wisdom to respond.

3 PROCESS



4 OBSERVABLE BEHAVIORS

- | NOTICE | EMPATHIZE | DISCERN | RESPOND | VERIFY |
|--|---|---|---|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Detects cues• Pauses before reacting• Spots non-routine human issues | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Listens first• Checks assumptions• Understands the other person's perspective | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Identifies needs, values, priorities, and the issue behind the stated request | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Adapts the response• Balances empathy with fairness and constraints• Acts appropriately | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Checks impact• Confirms understanding• Adjusts when needed |

5 COUNTER-BEHAVIORS / WARNING SIGNS

- | | |
|--|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Inattention• Projection• Premature problem-solving• Script dependence | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Surface-level interpretation• Empathy without action• Care without boundaries• Intention bias |
|--|--|

6 EVIDENCE THAT THE CAPABILITY IS BEING DEMONSTRATED

- | | |
|---|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Observation of an interaction• Identification of cues others might miss• Explanation of likely perspective and needs• Service-recovery rationale | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Modified procedure justified by context• Human-override explanation• Evidence that impact was checked |
|---|---|

7 POSSIBLE PROFICIENCY LEVELS



8 HUMAN + AI BOUNDARY

AI can inform Care by surfacing patterns and options. The human remains responsible for empathy, interpretation, contextual judgment, and the consequences of the response.





ADAPTABILITY

Adjusting intelligently when conditions change.



DEFINITION

Adaptability is the capacity to detect meaningful change, reassess assumptions, regulate one's response, and modify decisions, behaviors, or strategies while preserving effectiveness and alignment with what matters.



WHY IT MATTERS IN HOSPITALITY

Hospitality operates under frequent change—guest expectations shift, technology fails, staffing issues arise, demand moves, and plans break down. Adaptability matters because leaders must decide both what should change and what must remain stable. Values help determine what should be protected even when execution changes. AI can generate alternatives, but humans must judge whether change is warranted and aligned.

PROCESS



SENSE



REASSESS



REGULATE



ADJUST



LEARN



OBSERVABLE BEHAVIORS

- Sense: Notices changes in conditions, expectations, constraints, and weak signals.
- Reassess: Questions prior assumptions and identifies what is no longer valid.
- Regulate: Maintains composure under uncertainty and avoids impulsive reactions.
- Adjust: Changes behavior, priorities, communication, or strategy proportionately while protecting standards and values.
- Learn: Uses disruptions to update future decisions, routines, or processes.



COUNTER-BEHAVIORS / WARNING SIGNS

- Rigidity
- Change avoidance
- Overreaction
- Emotional hijacking
- Identity attachment
- Assumption persistence
- Value abandonment
- Random flexibility
- Failure to learn
- Technology dependence



EVIDENCE THAT THE CAPABILITY IS BEING DEMONSTRATED

- Explanation of what changed
- Identification of which assumption became invalid
- Before/after decision comparison
- Scenario analysis showing what must change vs. stay constant
- Reflection on regulation under disruption
- Modified plan rationale
- Use or rejection of AI alternatives with explanation



POSSIBLE PROFICIENCY LEVELS

- 1. Responsive Adaptability**
Adjusts when change is clear and the response is obvious.
- 2. Interpretive Adaptability**
Recognizes change independently and modifies behavior appropriately.
- 3. Strategic Adaptability**
Adapts under ambiguity while protecting key values and outcomes.
- 4. Adaptive Leadership**
Helps others navigate change and builds the team's adaptive capacity.



HUMAN + AI BOUNDARY

AI can expand the range of alternatives during change. The human remains responsible for deciding whether adaptation is needed, what must be protected, and what consequences the new direction may create.



PEOPLE.
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THINK

Framing the right problem and making defensible judgments.

WHY IT MATTERS IN HOSPITALITY

Hospitality decisions are often made with incomplete information, competing priorities, time pressure, and significant human consequences. A plausible answer may still be ethically weak or contextually wrong. AI can produce confident answers quickly, but humans must know what to question, what to verify, and when not to accept the recommendation.

DEFINITION

Think is the capacity to frame the right problem, examine evidence and assumptions, generate and compare alternatives, and make reasoned decisions while remaining accountable for the consequences.

PROCESS



FRAME

Distinguishes symptoms from the underlying problem and clarifies the real decision.



QUESTION

Challenges assumptions, seeks missing information, and considers alternative explanations.



EVALUATE

Tests evidence quality, verifies claims, and compares options using explicit criteria.



DECIDE

Weighs trade-offs, risks, values, and consequences, then explains the rationale.



REFLECT

Reviews reasoning quality and updates future decisions based on outcomes.



COUNTER-BEHAVIORS / WARNING SIGNS

Problem misframing

Binary thinking

Confirmation bias

Analysis paralysis

Assumption blindness

Premature closure

Authority dependence

Outcome bias

Evidence weakness

Responsibility transfer



EVIDENCE THAT THE CAPABILITY IS BEING DEMONSTRATED

Problem reframing

Decision memo

Assumption identification

Identification of missing or contradictory information

Verification of evidence or AI claims

Oral defense of a decision

Comparison of alternatives

Reflection showing revised reasoning



POSSIBLE PROFICIENCY LEVELS

1

Problem Recognition

Identifies the core issue and explains a reasonable conclusion.

2

Critical Analysis

Questions assumptions, evaluates evidence, and compares alternatives.

3

Complex Judgment

Makes defensible decisions under ambiguity and significant trade-offs.

4

Strategic Foresight

Anticipates broader consequences and improves decision quality beyond the immediate issue.



HUMAN + AI BOUNDARY

AI can generate information, analysis, alternatives, and recommendations. The human remains responsible for framing the problem, evaluating evidence and assumptions, determining what matters, and owning the final judgment.

CREATE EXCEPTIONAL EXPERIENCES

Designing value beyond competent delivery.

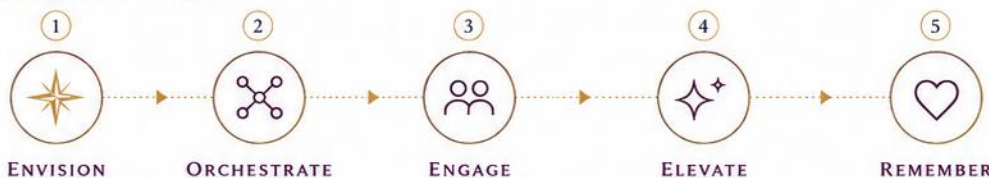
DEFINITION

Create Exceptional Experiences is the capacity to intentionally shape products, services, interactions, environments, and moments so that the resulting experience goes beyond competent delivery and produces distinctive value—functionally, emotionally, sensorially, socially, cognitively, or symbolically—for the people involved.

WHY IT MATTERS IN HOSPITALITY

Hospitality creates the conditions within which people experience products and services. Two organizations can deliver the same service outcome and create very different experiences. Exceptional experiences can arise through functional excellence, emotional impact, sensory richness, distinctiveness, personal relevance, or memory and transformation. AI can optimize and personalize, but humans remain responsible for deciding what kind of experience is worth creating and why.

THE EXPERIENCE CREATION PROCESS



OBSERVABLE BEHAVIORS

Defines the desired experience, not only the task, and identifies what could make it distinctive.

Aligns people, processes, space, timing, technology, and details into one coherent experience.

Creates participation, adjusts based on response, and treats experience as co-created when appropriate.

Adds value through surprise, personalization, aesthetics, authenticity, ease, recovery, or emotional resonance.

Focuses on what people will actually remember and refines the design through feedback.

COUNTER-BEHAVIORS / WARNING SIGNS

- Service-equivalence thinking
- Operational tunnel vision
- Novelty for novelty's sake

- Overengineering
- Touchpoint fragmentation
- Designer egocentrism

- Sensory neglect
- Standardization excess
- Underexecution

- Memory blindness
- Technology spectacle

EVIDENCE THAT THE CAPABILITY IS BEING DEMONSTRATED

- Journey redesign
- Experience concept
- Prototype or simulation
- Identification of high-impact moments

- Experience dimensions activated and why
- Co-creation design
- Service-recovery redesign
- Guest feedback

- Evidence of stronger memory, advocacy, satisfaction, or engagement

POSSIBLE PROFICIENCY LEVELS

1
Reliable Delivery
Creates experiences that work consistently and avoid obvious negative cues.

2
Experience Enhancement
Improves selected moments through personalization, creativity, sensory elements, ease, participation, or emotional impact.

3
Experience Orchestration
Integrates multiple touchpoints into a coherent, distinctive, and memorable experience.

4
Experience Innovation
Reimagines how experiential value can be created and establishes approaches others can scale.

HUMAN + AI BOUNDARY



AI can increasingly design components of an experience. Humans remain responsible for deciding what experience is worth creating, interpreting lived response, integrating context and culture, and judging when optimization helps—or destroys—what makes the experience exceptional.



PEOPLE.
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HUMAN CONNECTION

Building authentic, reciprocal, trust-based relationships.



DEFINITION

Human Connection is the capacity to create authentic, reciprocal relationships in which people experience presence, trust, mutual recognition, and a meaningful sense of connection with one another.



WHY IT MATTERS IN HOSPITALITY

Hospitality is inherently relational, but interaction alone does not create connection. A guest can receive excellent service and still experience the employee as distant or scripted. Connection changes the nature of the exchange by increasing trust, candor, collaboration, help-seeking, loyalty, and return. Technology can personalize communication, but personalization is not the same as relationship.

PROCESS



PRESENCE



ATTUNEMENT



RECIPROCITY



TRUST



CONTINUITY



OBSERVABLE BEHAVIORS

- Presence: Gives sustained attention and creates space for the other person.
- Attunement: Notices interpersonal cues and adapts communication appropriately.
- Reciprocity: Creates two-way exchange and invites participation instead of one-way delivery.
- Trust: Behaves consistently, communicates honestly, protects boundaries, and repairs trust when needed.
- Continuity: Builds on prior interactions and creates conditions for future relationship.



COUNTER-BEHAVIORS / WARNING SIGNS

- Transactional interaction
- Script dependence
- One-way communication
- Forced intimacy
- Trust inconsistency
- Performative warmth
- Pseudo-personalization
- Distracted presence
- Selective connection
- Relationship neglect
- Technology substitution



EVIDENCE THAT THE CAPABILITY IS BEING DEMONSTRATED

- Observation of a live interaction
- Evidence of active participation by both people
- Adapted communication based on cues
- Trust-building or trust-repair example
- Feedback describing relationship quality
- Continuity beyond immediate transaction
- Reflection on what strengthened or weakened connection
- Use of technology to support rather than replace relationship



POSSIBLE PROFICIENCY LEVELS

1
Engaged Presence
Creates attentive, respectful interactions.

2
Relational Attunement
Reads dynamics and creates reciprocal exchanges.

3
Trust Building
Develops and repairs relationships through credibility and consistency.

4
Relationship Leadership
Creates environments in which trust and strong relationships become cultural norms.



HUMAN + AI BOUNDARY

AI can facilitate, personalize, and simulate elements of connection. Human beings remain responsible for authentic reciprocity, trustworthiness, relational accountability, and the consequences of the relationship.